

WEEK 6

Print Edition

Week 6 Study Guide

Pericardium, San Jiao, Gallbladder & Liver Channels

PC (9 pts) + SJ (23 pts) + GB (44 pts) + LR (14 pts) = 90 Points

This Document Covers:

- Pericardium Meridian of Hand-Jueyin (PC1-PC9) with MOA + CAM figures
- PC has ZERO crossing points -- shares this trait with only Heart (Wk4)
- San Jiao Meridian of Hand-Shaoyang (SJ1-SJ23) with MOA + CAM figures
- SJ5 opens the Yang Wei Mai (confluent, pairs with GB41)
- Gallbladder Meridian of Foot-Shaoyang (GB1-GB44) with MOA + CAM figures
- GB crossing-point count flagged (12 on slide / 9 named) -- pending Dr. Zhang
- Liver Meridian of Foot-Jueyin (LR1-LR14) with MOA + CAM figures
- LR is the only channel reaching the vertex; LR3+LI4 'Four Gates' combination

QUIZ 5 (Week 7) covers: PC, SJ, GB & LR material.

PC/SJ/GB/LR are taught this week.

MOA pp.367-472 | CAM pp.77-82 | Slides: Dr. Vivian Zhang, Week 6

The Pericardium Meridian of Hand-Jueyin

Ministerial Fire | 7-9 PM | 9 Points

Pertaining Pericardium

Connecting San Jiao

Back-Shu BL14

Front-Mu CV17

Yuan-Source PC7

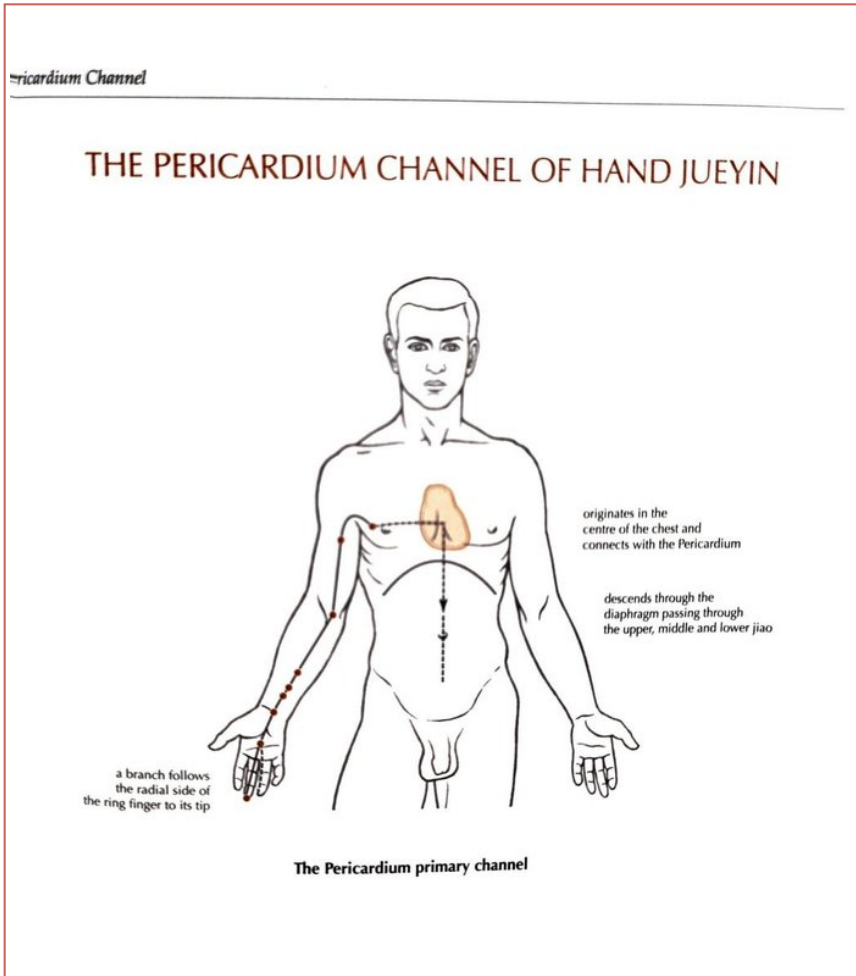
Luo PC6

He-Sea PC3

Internal Running Course

Direction: Chest -> Hand (Yin, Hand)

Position: Middle line of the anterior/medial arm -- between LU (anterior) and HT (posterior)



- 1 Originates in the chest, emerges and enters its pertaining organ, the Pericardium
- 2 Descends through the diaphragm to the abdomen, connecting successively with the Upper, Middle, and Lower Jiao (San Jiao)
- 3 BRANCH: from inside the chest, emerges at the costal region 3 cun below the anterior axillary fold (PC1 Tianchi), ascends to the axilla
- 4 Runs down the medial aspect of the upper arm, BETWEEN the Lung channel (anterior) and Heart channel (posterior)
- 5 Crosses the cubital fossa (PC3 Quze), continues down the forearm between the tendons of palmaris longus and flexor carpi radialis
- 6 Crosses the wrist (PC7 Daling), through the palm (PC8 Laogong), ending at the tip of the middle finger (PC9 Zhongchong)
- 7 BRANCH: arises from the palm at PC8 Laogong, runs along the ring finger to its tip, links with the SAN JIAO channel

Functions

- Protects the Heart -- 'Pericardium is an organ that protects the Heart' (transcript); shares many indications with HT (palpitations, chest/mental disorders)
- Governs Blood circulation and the vessels alongside HT; regulates the sexual/reproductive function (San Jiao lower jiao connection)
- ZERO crossing points -- exam trap identical to HT (both are the two channels with no crossing points)
- Runs on the MIDDLE line of the arm, between LU (anterior) and HT (posterior) -- 'in-between' position is exam-testable
- PC6 + PC8 are the most clinically-used points per the professor (safe, effective, on the hand/forearm) -- points ON THE CHEST (PC1) are used cautiously due to pneumothorax risk

Point Combinations

PC6 + SP4

The linked-vessel pair -- both are Luo + Confluent points opening related Extraordinary Vessels (Yin Wei Mai + Chong Mai). Classic combination for chest, heart, stomach, and epigastric disorders.

PC7 + HT7

Shu-Stream/Yuan-Source points of the two Fire-family Yin hand channels -- combined to calm the Shen; anxiety, insomnia, palpitations.

PC3 + LU5

He-Sea points of neighboring Yin hand channels at the elbow -- combined to clear heat and descend rebellious Qi from the chest.

The Pericardium Meridian (PC) – External Running Course & CAM Figures Ministerial Fire | 9 Points

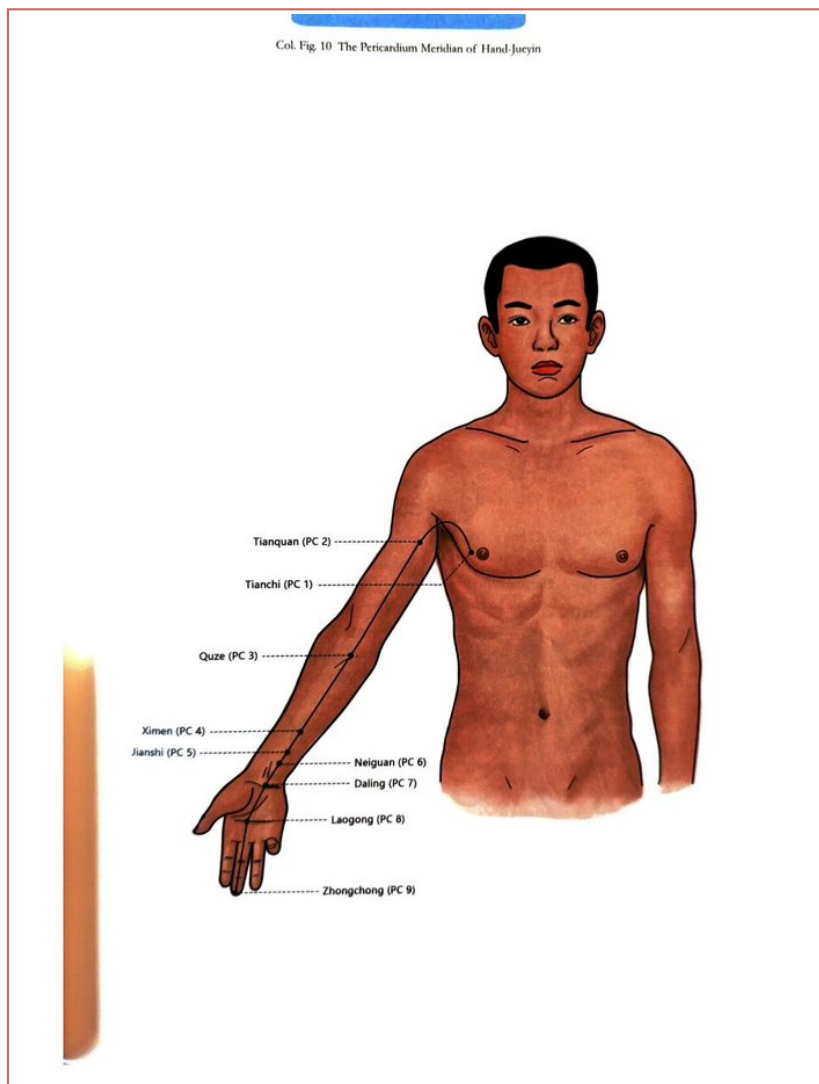
Pertaining Pericardium	Connecting San Jiao	Back-Shu BL14	Front-Mu CV17	Yuan-Source PC7	Luo PC6	He-Sea PC3
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Pt	Pinyin	Location & Category
PC1	Tianchi	4th ICS, 1 cun lateral to the nipple.
PC2	Tianquan	2 cun below the anterior axillary fold, between the two heads of biceps brachii.
PC3	Quze	HE-SEA. Medial end of cubital crease, ulnar side of biceps tendon, elbow slightly flexed.
PC4	Ximen	XI-CLEFT, 5 cun proximal to the wrist crease, between the tendons of palmaris longus and flexor carpi radialis.
PC5	Jianshi	JING-RIVER, 3 cun proximal to the wrist crease, same tendon groove.
PC6	Neiguan	LUO-CONNECTING + CONFLUENT (opens Yin Wei Mai, pairs with SP4). 2 cun proximal to the wrist crease, same tendon groove. HIGH-YIELD: nausea/vomiting, motion sickness, chest oppression, palpitations, calms the Shen.
PC7	Daling	SHU-STREAM + YUAN-SOURCE. Midpoint of the wrist crease, between the tendons of palmaris longus and flexor carpi radialis. Ghost point (Ghost Cave).
PC8	Laogong	YING-SPRING. Center of the palm, where the tip of the middle finger touches when a fist is made. Emergency point -- mental disorders, palpitations, syncope.
PC9	Zhongchong	JING-WELL. Center of the tip of the middle finger. Last point of PC; emergency/resuscitation point.

Crossing Points -- Specifics

A Crossing Point (also called a Meeting Point -- same concept, both terms appear across these materials) is a point where one channel's pathway physically crosses, touches, or runs directly alongside another channel's pathway. At that shared location, a single point can be understood as belonging to more than one channel. This is a TOPOGRAPHICAL fact about where pathways cross in space -- it is NOT one of the 14 special-point categories (Yuan-Source, Luo-Connecting, etc. -- see the Special Points Decoder for those). A channel can have ZERO crossing points if its entire pathway never touches another channel's points along the way -- PC and HT are the only two.

- PC has NO crossing points -- no other channel crosses PC's pathway, and PC crosses no other channel's points. (Only PC and HT share this trait.)



CAM Col. Fig. – Pericardium Meridian

The San Jiao Meridian of Hand-Shaoyang

Ministerial Fire | 9–11 PM | 23 Points

Pertaining San Jiao

Connecting Pericardium

Back-Shu BL22

Front-Mu CV5

Yuan-Source SJ4

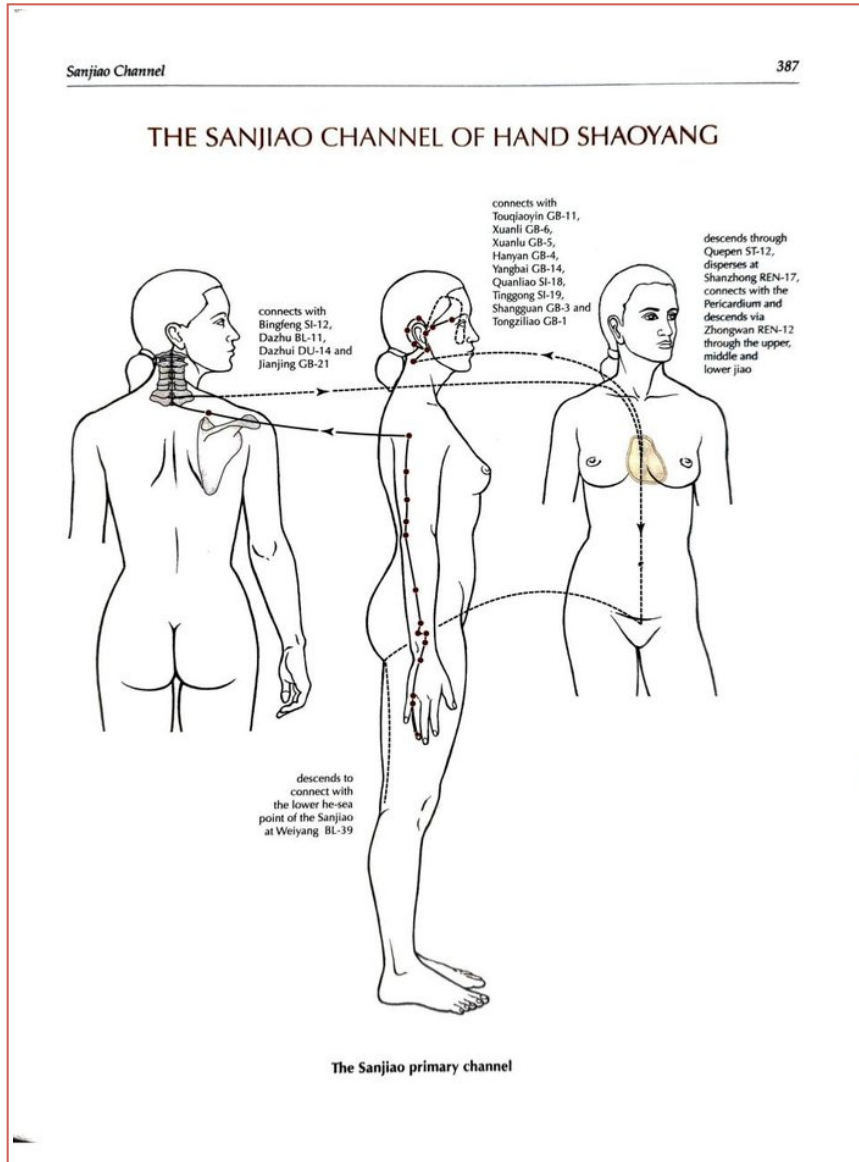
Luo SJ5

He-Sea SJ10

Internal Running Course

Direction: Hand → Head (Yang, Hand)

Position: Middle line, posterior forearm/upper arm -- between SI (posterior) and LI (anterior)



1. Originates at the tip of the ring finger (SJ1 Guanchong)
2. Runs upward between the 4th and 5th metacarpal bones, along the dorsal wrist, to the lateral forearm between radius and ulna
3. Passes the olecranon, ascends the lateral upper arm, reaches the shoulder -- crosses BEHIND the Gallbladder channel there
4. Winds to the supraclavicular fossa, spreads in the chest to connect with the Pericardium
5. Descends through the diaphragm to the abdomen, enters its pertaining organ: Upper, Middle, and Lower Jiao
6. BRANCH: from the chest, ascends through the supraclavicular fossa, up the neck, along the posterior border of the ear, to the corner of the anterior hairline, then turns down to the cheek, terminates infraorbitally
7. BRANCH (auricular): arises retroauricularly, enters the ear, exits in front of the ear, crosses the cheek branch, reaches SJ23 Sizhukong, links with the GALLBLADDER channel at the outer canthus

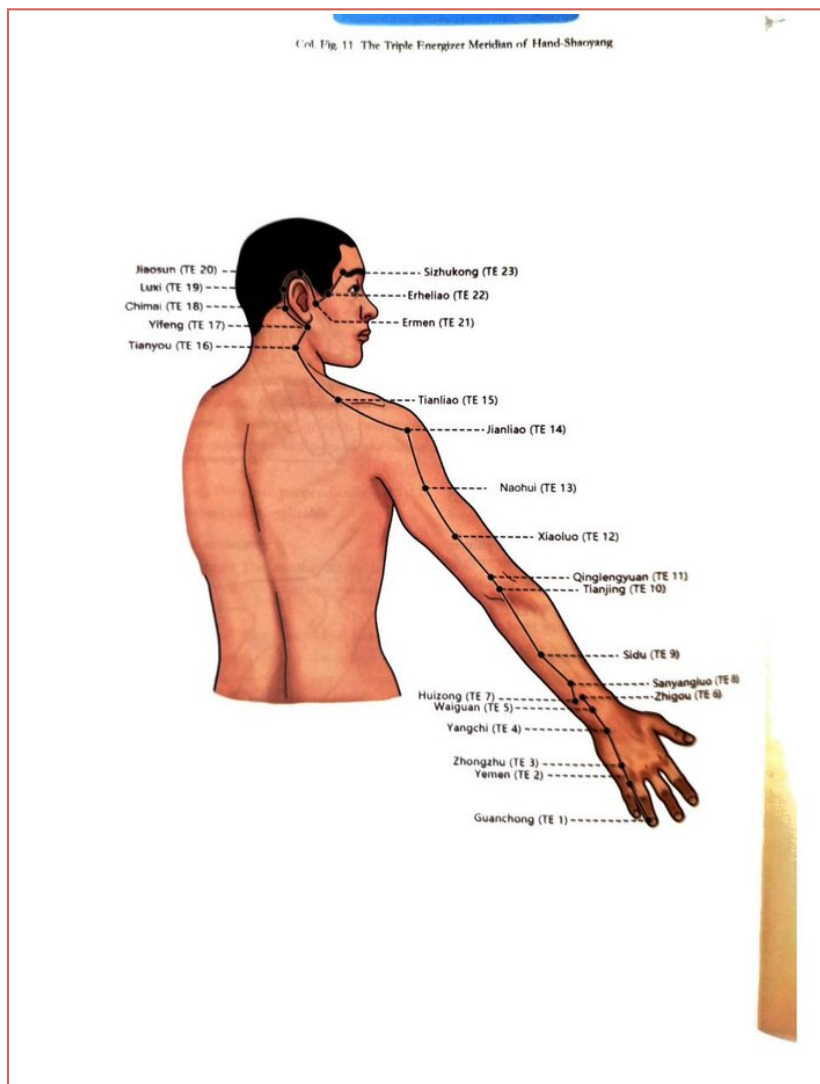
Functions

- No physical organ -- a 'function organ' governing the Upper/Middle/Lower Jiao (fluid pathways and overall qi transformation)
- Governs water passage/metabolism -- transcript: 'it can control the movement of water'
- Shares extensive crossing points with GB around the head, ear, and shoulder (both are Shaoyang channels -- 'same finger of Doctor Bobo' / same-name channel rule)
- SJ5 opens the Yang Wei Mai (paired with GB41) -- treats exterior wind-heat / alternating chills and fever
- Active 9–11 PM -- transcript: this is why we should sleep during this window, as San Jiao 'connects all organs' and needs rest

The San Jiao Meridian (SJ) – External Running Course & CAM Figures Ministerial Fire | 23 Points

Pertaining San Jiao	Connecting Pericardium	Back-Shu BL22	Front-Mu CV5	Yuan-Source SJ4	Luo SJ5	He-Sea SJ10
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Pt	Pinyin	Location & Category
SJ1	Guanchong	JING-WELL. Ulnar side of the ring finger, ~0.1 cun from the corner of the nail. First point of SJ.
SJ2	Yemen	YING-SPRING. Between the 4th and 5th fingers, proximal to the margin of the web.
SJ3	Zhongzhu	SHU-STREAM. Dorsum of hand, between the 4th and 5th metacarpal bones, in the depression proximal to the MCP joints.
SJ4	Yangchi	YUAN-SOURCE. Dorsal wrist crease, in the depression lateral to the tendon of extensor digitorum.
SJ5	Waiguan	LUO-CONNECTING + CONFLUENT (opens Yang Wei Mai, pairs with GB41). 2 cun proximal to the dorsal wrist crease, between radius and ulna. HIGH-YIELD: exterior wind-heat/common cold, treats the exterior via the Yang Wei Mai link.
SJ6	Zhigou	JING-RIVER. 3 cun proximal to the dorsal wrist crease, between radius and ulna.
SJ7	Huizong	XI-CLEFT. Same level as SJ6, one finger-breadth to the ulnar side.
SJ8	Sanyangluo	4 cun proximal to the dorsal wrist crease.
SJ9	Sidu	5 cun below the olecranon, between radius and ulna.
SJ10	Tianjing	HE-SEA. 1 cun proximal to the olecranon, in the depression above it, elbow flexed.
SJ11	Qinglengyuan	1 cun above SJ10.
SJ12	Xiaoluo	Midpoint between SJ10/olecranon and shoulder.
SJ13	Naohui	Posterior border of deltoid muscle.
SJ14	Jianliao	Posterior/inferior to the acromion.
SJ15	Tianliao	CROSSING (w/ GB21). Midpoint between GV14 and the acromion, superior scapular angle.
SJ16	Tianyou	WINDOW OF HEAVEN. Posterior border of SCM, level with the mandible angle.
SJ17	Yifeng	CROSSING (w/ GB). Posterior to the earlobe, in the depression between the mastoid process and the mandible. HIGH-YIELD: tinnitus, deafness, facial paralysis, TMJ.
SJ18	Chimai	Center of the mastoid process.
SJ19	Luxi	Posterior to the ear, behind SJ18.
SJ20	Jiaosun	CROSSING (w/ GB, SI). Directly above the ear apex, within the hairline.
SJ21	Ermen	Supratragic notch, anterior to the supratragic notch, mouth slightly open. HIGH-YIELD: tinnitus, deafness, ear pain.
SJ22	Erheliao	CROSSING (w/ GB, SI). Anterior/superior to SJ21, at the hairline of the temple, posterior to the superficial temporal artery.
SJ23	Sizhukong	Lateral end of the eyebrow, in the depression. LAST point of SJ, links to GB channel.



CAM Col. Fig. — San Jiao Meridian

Crossing Points -- Specifics

- SJ crosses BEHIND the Gallbladder channel at the shoulder (per transcript: SJ 'goes across and passes behind the Gallbladder meridian of Foot-Shaoyang' at the shoulder region)
- SJ15 Tianliao is a crossing point shared with GB21 Jianjing (both at the shoulder/scapular region)
- SJ meets GB infraorbitally near ST/GB5-6 region on the facial branch
- SJ crosses GV14 Dazhui at the top of the shoulder before entering the supraclavicular fossa

The Gallbladder Meridian of Foot-Shaoyang

Wood | 11 PM-1 AM | 44 Points

Pertaining Gallbladder

Connecting Liver

Back-Shu BL19

Front-Mu GB24

Yuan-Source GB40

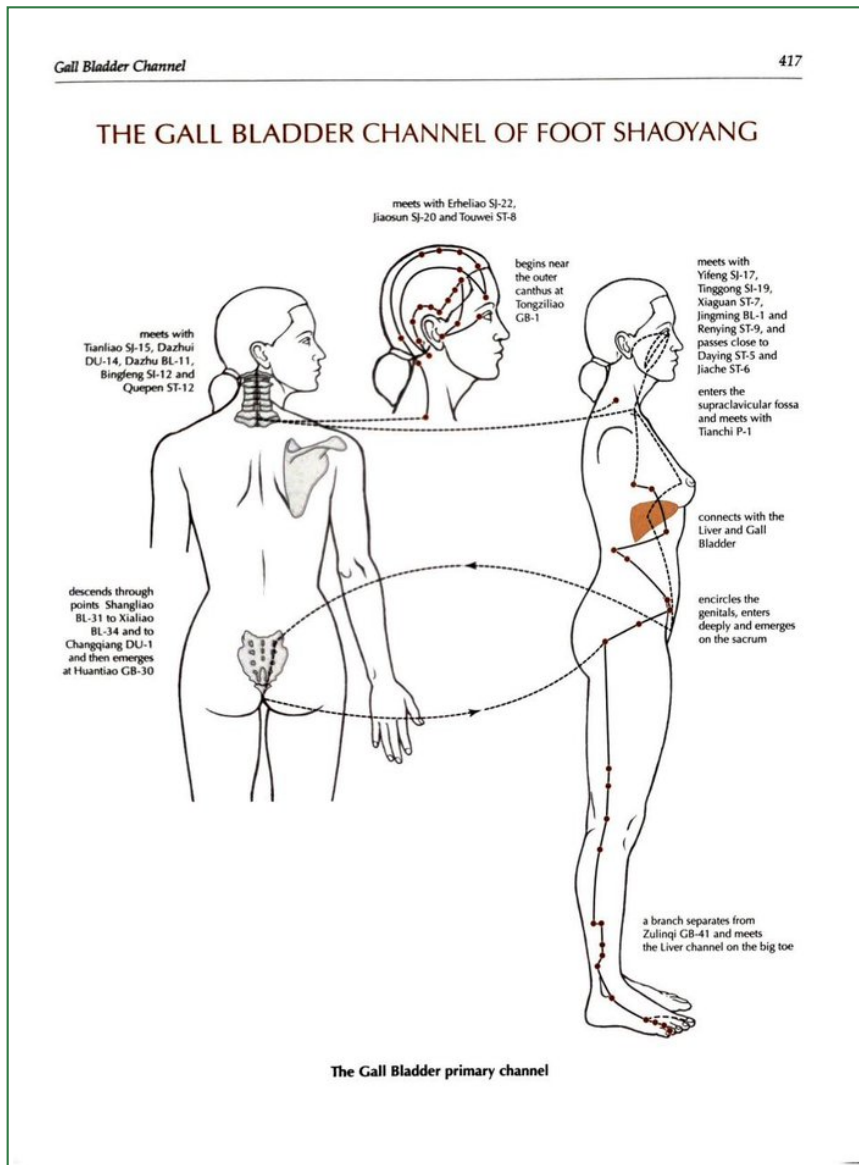
Luo GB37

He-Sea GB34 (also Hui-Meeting Sinews)

Internal Running Course

Direction: Head → Foot (Yang, Foot)

Position: Lateral side of head, trunk, and leg -- unique zigzag/'Z-shape' course on the head



- 1 Originates at the outer canthus (GB1 Tongziliao)
- 2 Ascends to the corner of the forehead (GB4 Hanyan), then curves down to the retroauricular region (GB20 Fengchi)
- 3 Runs along the side of the neck, in FRONT of San Jiao to the shoulder, then turns back and crosses BEHIND San Jiao, down to the supraclavicular fossa
- 4 BRANCH (head): from behind the ear, enters the ear, exits in front, to the posterior aspect of the outer canthus
- 5 BRANCH (canthus): from the outer canthus down to ST5/6 region, meets San Jiao infraorbitally, descends to the neck, rejoins the main channel at the supraclavicular fossa
- 6 MAIN INTERNAL: from the supraclavicular fossa, descends through the diaphragm, connects with the Liver, enters its pertaining organ the Gallbladder; continues through the hypochondriac region, emerges at the inguinal region (ST30 area), circles the pubic hair margin, transverses to the hip (GB30 Huantiao)
- 7 STRAIGHT/EXTERNAL PORTION: from the supraclavicular fossa, descends in front of the axilla, along the lateral chest and free ends of the floating ribs (GB24-GB25), to the hip where it joins the internal branch (GB30)
- 8 Continues down the lateral thigh and knee, along the anterior fibula, to GB39 Xuanzhong, in front of the external malleolus, along the dorsum of the foot to the lateral tip of the 4th toe (GB44)
- 9 BRANCH: from the dorsum of the foot, to the great toe, links with the LIVER channel

Functions

- 3rd largest channel (44 points) after BL (67) and ST (45)
- Unique zigzag ('Z-shape') course on the head -- exam-testable visual signature
- GB34 is the Hui-Meeting Point for sinews/tendons -- master point for tendon/ligament disorders
- GB41 opens the Dai Mai (paired with SJ5) -- the only channel whose confluent point connects to an EV that encircles the waist
- Alternating fever and chills + bitter taste in the mouth = classic Shaoyang syndrome, specific to GB (transcript emphasized this repeatedly)
- GB21 is FORBIDDEN in pregnancy -- strong descending/labor-inducing action (matches GB's overall 'descending' channel character)

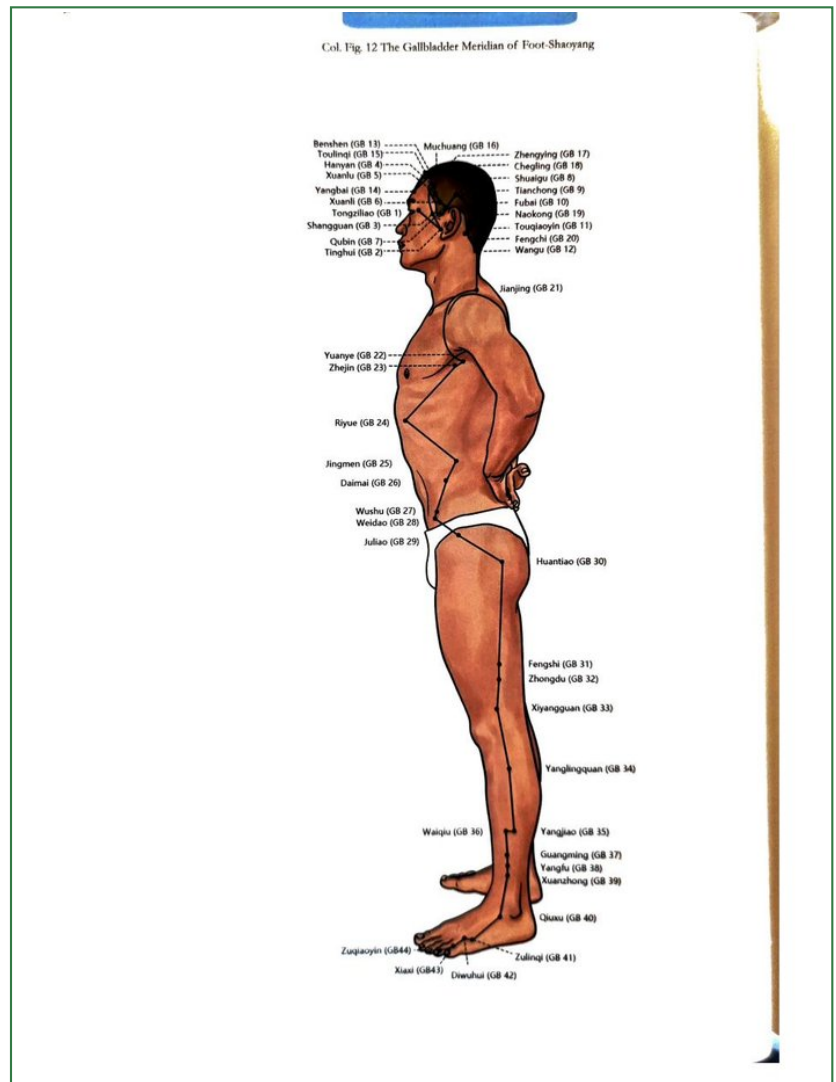
The Gallbladder Meridian (GB) - External Running Course & CAM Figures Wood | 44 Points

Pertaining Gallbladder	Connecting Liver	Back-Shu BL19	Front-Mu GB24	Yuan-Source GB40	Luo GB37	He-Sea GB34 (also Hui-Meeting Sinews)
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Pt	Pinyin	Location & Category
Head/neck (GB1-GB20)		
GB1	Tongziliao	CROSSING (w/ SI, ST). 0.5 cun lateral to the outer canthus. First point of GB.
GB2	Tinghui	Anterior to the intertragic notch, posterior to the condyloid process of the mandible.
GB3	Shangguan	CROSSING. Upper border of the zygomatic arch, anterior to the ear.
GB4-GB13 (Hanyan...Benshen et al)		Several CROSSING. Zigzag course across the temporal/forehead region -- the 'Z-shape' unique to GB on the head.
GB14	Yangbai	CROSSING. 1 cun above the midpoint of the eyebrow.
GB20	Fengchi	CROSSING (w/ SJ). Below the occiput, in the depression between sternocleidomastoid and trapezius. HIGH-YIELD (Wind Gate): headache, dizziness, common cold, hypertension, eye disorders.
GB21	Jianjing	CROSSING (w/ SJ, ST, ren-adjacent). Midpoint between GV14 and the acromion, at the highest point of the shoulder. FORBIDDEN IN PREGNANCY -- strong descending action, can induce labor.
Trunk (GB22-GB27)		
GB24	Riyue	FRONT-MU (Gallbladder). 6th ICS, on the mamillary line.
GB25	Jingmen	FRONT-MU (Kidney). Free end (anterior/inferior border) of the 12th rib.
GB26/27	Daimai / Wushu	CROSSING (w/ Dai Mai). Below the free end of the 11th rib / anterior superior iliac spine level -- where the Dai Mai (Girdle Vessel) actually wraps the body.
Leg (GB30-GB44)		
GB30	Huantiao	CROSSING (w/ BL). Junction of lateral 1/3 and medial 2/3 of the line from the greater trochanter to the sacral hiatus.
GB34	Yanglingquan	HE-SEA + HUI-MEETING (Sinews/Tendons). Anterior/inferior to the head of the fibula. HIGH-YIELD: master point for tendons/sinews, hypochondriac pain, jaundice.
GB37	Guangming	LUO-CONNECTING. 5 cun above the tip of the external malleolus, anterior to the fibula.
GB39	Xuanzhong	HUI-MEETING (Marrow). 3 cun above the tip of the external malleolus, between the fibula and the tendons of peroneus longus/brevis.
GB40	QiuXu	YUAN-SOURCE. Anterior/inferior to the external malleolus, lateral to the tendon of extensor digitorum longus.
GB41	Zulinqi	SHU-STREAM + CONFLUENT (opens Dai Mai, pairs w/ SJ5). Between the 4th/5th metatarsal bones, lateral to the tendon of extensor digitorum longus.
GB44	Zuqiaoyin	JING-WELL. Lateral side of the 4th toe, ~0.1 cun from the corner of the nail. LAST point of GB, links to LR channel.

Crossing Points -- Specifics

- GB runs IN FRONT of San Jiao along the side of the neck to the shoulder, THEN turns back and crosses BEHIND San Jiao down to the supraclavicular fossa -- GB and SJ cross each other TWICE in this region (verified, transcript)
- GB1 Tongziliao (first point) is a crossing point shared with SI and ST
- GB21 Jianjing is a crossing point shared with SJ, ST, and is near GV14
- GB's zigzag head course crosses/shares territory with SJ around the ear repeatedly -- both are Shaoyang channels ('same finger of Doctor Bobo' rule from transcript)
- GB30 Huantiao is a crossing point shared with BL



CAM Col. Fig. -- Gallbladder Meridian

The Liver Meridian of Foot-Jueyin

Wood | 1-3 AM | 14 Points

Pertaining Liver

Connecting Gallbladder

Back-Shu BL18

Front-Mu LR14

Yuan-Source LR3

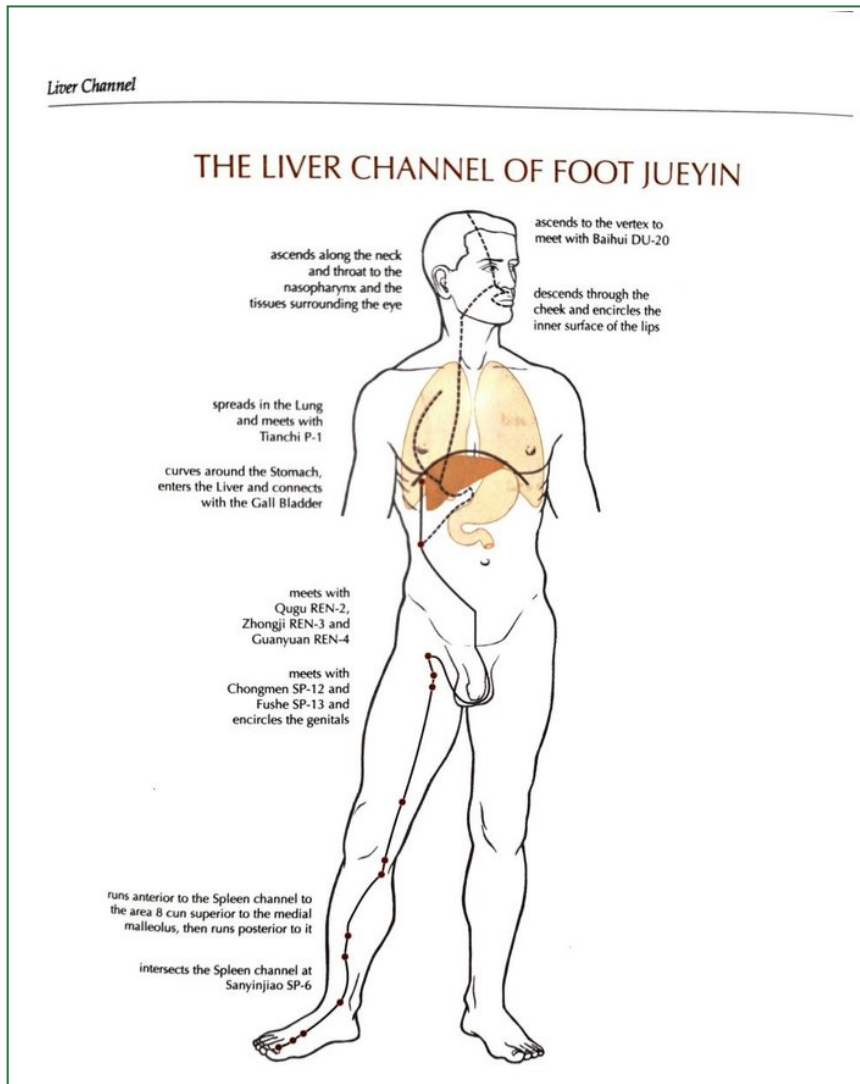
Luo LR5

He-Sea LR8

Internal Running Course

Direction: Foot -> Chest (Yin, Foot)

Position: Medial leg -- crosses IN FRONT of SP at 8 cun above the medial malleolus (exception to normal order); reaches highest of any channel via the vertex branch



- 1 Begins at the lateral side of the great toe (LR1 Dadun), runs along the dorsum of the foot
- 2 At 8 cun above the medial malleolus, crosses IN FRONT of the Spleen channel (exception to the usual anterior/middle/posterior leg-Yin order)
- 3 Ascends the medial knee and thigh to the pubic region, circles the genitals, enters the lower abdomen
- 4 Curves around the Stomach, enters the Liver (its pertaining organ), connects with the Gallbladder
- 5 Continues up through the diaphragm, spreads through the costal/hypochondriac region
- 6 Ascends along the posterior trachea/throat, connects with the eye system, EMERGES AT THE FOREHEAD, meets the Governing Vessel AT THE VERTEX (GV20 Baihui) -- unique among primary channels for reaching the vertex
- 7 BRANCH (cheek): from the eye system, descends to the cheek, circles the inner lips
- 8 BRANCH (internal): from the Liver, through the diaphragm, into the Lung, connects with the LUNG channel (completes the 12-channel cycle back to LU)

Functions

- Governs the smooth flow of Qi throughout the body (Liver Qi stagnation is the most common TCM pattern taught from this channel)
- Stores Blood; opens into the eyes (Liver Blood nourishes the eyes -- explains why LR reaches the eye system and the vertex)
- ONLY primary channel to reach the VERTEX (GV20) -- vertex headache = think Liver, per transcript's clinical Q&A
- Crosses IN FRONT of SP at 8 cun above the medial malleolus -- the single exception to the standard leg-Yin ordering rule
- LR3 + LI4 = the 'Four Gates' -- classic combination taught this week, smooths Qi and moves Blood, used for pain of many origins
- LR13 carries a DOUBLE special-point designation (Front-Mu of SP + Hui-Meeting of all Zang) -- easy to mix up on an exam
- Completes the 12-channel Qi cycle by connecting back to LU inside the body -- 'the total basic circulation of the 12 primary meridians'

The Liver Meridian (LR) – External Running Course & CAM Figures

Wood | 14 Points

Pertaining Liver	Connecting Gallbladder	Back-Shu BL18	Front-Mu LR14	Yuan-Source LR3	Luo LR5	He-Sea LR8
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Pt	Pinyin	Location & Category
LR1	Dadun	JING-WELL. Lateral side of the great toe, ~0.1 cun from the corner of the nail. First point of LR.
LR2	Xingjian	YING-SPRING. Web margin between the 1st and 2nd toes.
LR3	Taichong	SHU-STREAM + YUAN-SOURCE. Dorsum of foot, in the depression distal to the junction of the 1st/2nd metatarsal bones. HIGHEST-YIELD LR POINT: smooths Liver Qi, subdues Liver Yang/wind, pairs with LI4 (the 'Four Gates') -- classic combination for pain and to move Qi and Blood.
LR4	Zhongfeng	JING-RIVER. Anterior to the medial malleolus, medial to tibialis anterior tendon.
LR5	Ligou	LUO-CONNECTING. 5 cun above the tip of the medial malleolus, on the medial tibial surface.
LR6	Zhongdu	XI-CLEFT. 7 cun above the tip of the medial malleolus, medial tibial surface.
LR8	Ququan	HE-SEA. Medial end of the popliteal crease, posterior to the medial condyle, knee flexed. HIGH-YIELD: nourishes Liver Blood/Yin, genital/gynecological disorders.
LR13	Zhangmen	FRONT-MU (Spleen) + HUI-MEETING (Zang/solid organs). Free end of the 11th floating rib, level with LR14. HIGH-YIELD: dual special-point status -- Front-Mu for SP and Hui-Meeting for all 5 Zang.
LR14	Qimen	FRONT-MU (Liver). 6th ICS, directly below the nipple, on the mamillary line.

Crossing Points -- Specifics

Reminder: a Crossing/Meeting Point is a point where two channels' pathways physically cross or touch -- a topographical fact, not one of the 14 special-point categories. Full definition on the PC page.

- The SPLEEN channel crosses IN FRONT of LIVER at a point 8 cun above the medial malleolus (this is the exact quiz-style fact: 'which meridian crosses in front of LR at SP9' -> answer: Spleen) -- this is the ONE exception to the normal medial-leg Yin channel order (normally SP is anterior-most)
- LR shares crossing points with CV (2 points) and SP (1 point) around the genital/lower abdomen region
- LR reaches the VERTEX and meets the Governing Vessel at GV20 Baihui -- a crossing point on top of the head

Point Combinations

LR3 + LI4

The 'Four Gates' (Si Guan) -- pairs the Yuan-Source points of LR and LI. Smooths Liver Qi, moves Qi and Blood broadly; used for pain of many origins.

LR3 + SP6

Both regulate Liver Blood and the lower jiao -- common combination for menstrual and gynecological disorders.

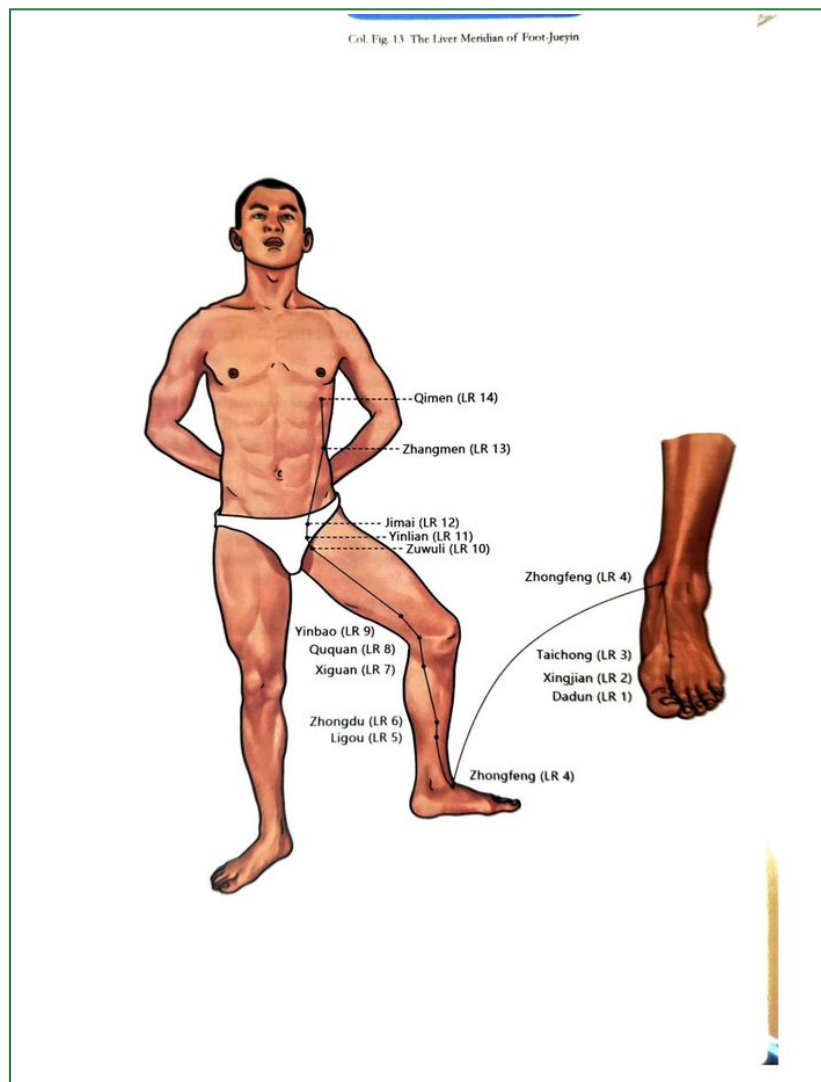
LR14 + LR13

LR's own Front-Mu plus SP's Front-Mu (which LR13 also serves, as Hui-Meeting of Zang) -- used together for Liver-Spleen disharmony.

LR8 + KI10

He-Sea points of neighboring Yin foot channels at the knee -- nourish Liver and Kidney Yin/Blood together ('Liver and Kidney share the same source').

Quick compare vs. neighbors: SP (Earth, 21 pts) -- LR (Wood, 14 pts) -- KI (Water, 27 pts). All three run Foot -> Chest/Abdomen on the medial leg. LR is the only one of the three that reaches the vertex (GV20).



CAM Col. Fig. – Liver Meridian